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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025

Third SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG3DSEFDGA00 - DISPLAY MERCHANDISING

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Short Answer Questions

Answer any **10** questions

Each question carries **2** marks

1. State two benefits of interior displays. [K] / [CO1, CO2]

Ans:-

- Attract Customers' Attention
- Communicate Product Information
- Create An Engaging Atmosphere
- Drive Sales
- Reinforce The Brand's Identity

2. State the primary function of racks in an apparel store? [K] / [CO3]

Ans:-

Racks Allow For Easy Browsing And Are Suitable For Both Front-Of-Store And Stock-Heavy Areas. They Help Organize Clothing By Size, Style, Or Category.

3. Describe how platforms improve the visual appeal of a display. [K] / [CO3]

Ans:-

Platforms Are Raised Flat Surfaces Used To Elevate And Spotlight Specific Products Or Design Elements In A Retail Display. Often Used In Window Displays Or To Showcase Mannequins And Featured Items, Platforms Draw Attention By Raising Products Above Floor Level. They Also Help Create Depth And Dimension Within The Visual Merchandising Layout.

4. What type of aisles are commonly found in a herringbone layout? [K] / [CO1, CO2]

Ans:-

Slender And Long Aisles

5. Define window signage. [K] / [CO4]

Ans:-

Window Signage Is Placed On Or Around Storefront Windows. It Is Highly Visible And Used To Attract Attention, Announce Sales, Or Promote New Arrivals. Since Windows Are Key Visual Hotspots, Signage Here Must Be Creative And Compelling.

6. What is the purpose of visual merchandising in retail? [K] / [CO1]

Ans:-

- Attract Customers
- Create Brand Image
- Showcase Products
- Drive Sales
- Enhance Customer Experience
- Differentiate From Competitors
- Communicate Product Information

7. Give one example of a seasonal prop and one of a festival prop. [K] / [CO3]

Ans:-

Seasonal Props/Festival Props :- Snowflakes, Reindeer, And Christmas Trees During December; Diyas And Rangoli Patterns For Diwali In India.

8. Define signage in visual merchandising. [K] / [CO4]

Ans:-

Signage Refers To Visual Graphics Or Displays That Communicate Information To Customers. In A Retail Environment, Signage Is Essential For Guiding, Informing, Promoting, And Creating Brand Identity. It Helps In Drawing Attention To Products, Navigating Store Layout, And Delivering Marketing Messages Effectively.

9. Define Interior signage. [K] / [CO4]

Ans:-

Interior Signage Is Found Inside The Store And Helps In Enhancing The Customer's Shopping Experience. It Helps With Navigation, Product Information, And Brand Storytelling.

10. Identify the two lighting types commonly used in retail. [K] / [CO4]

Ans:-

Ambient Lighting, Accent Lighting, Spot Lighting, LED Strip Lighting

11. Mention any two cool colors. [U] / [CO4]

Ans:-

Blue, Blue Violet, Violet, Blue Green, Green Etc…

12. What is an example of artwork props in a boutique? [K] / [CO3]

Ans:-

Paintings, Sculptures Etc…

[2x10 = 20]

Part B

Long Answer Questions

Answer any **5** questions

Each question carries **4** marks

13. Explain how colors communicate brand identity. [U] / [CO4]

Ans:-

Color Acts As A Powerful, Non-Verbal Communication Tool, Influencing Shopper Behavior, Guiding Their Perception Of The Brand, And Encouraging Purchases.

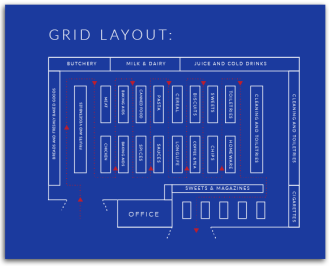
- Red: Creates Urgency, Increases Appetite → Used In Sales, Food Courts.
- Blue: Trustworthy, Calm → Electronics, Corporate, Financial Brands.
- Yellow: Cheerful, Attention-Grabbing → Children's Products, Casual Brands.
- Green: Freshness, Nature → Eco-Friendly, Organic Products.
- Black: Luxury, Power → Premium Fashion, Jewellery.

14. What type of floor plan does a grid layout follow? [K] / [CO1,CO2]

Ans:-

GRID LAYOUT

This Floor Plan Is Pretty Straightforward: It Utilizes Repetitive Patterns Through The Use Of Parallel Shelves. This Layout Works Best In Groceries, Big Box Stores, Drugstore, And Convenience Stores — Basically, Stores That Sell Different Categories Of Shelf-Stocked Goods Like Canned Food, Hardware, Toys, Homewares, Or Books. The Main Advantage Of Grid Retail Store Layouts Is That They Are Economical: They Maximize Every Inch Of Floor Space, Including Corners. They're Also Easy For Store Owners To Categorize. Straight Floor Plans Are Also A Cinch For Customers To Navigate And Help Save Time. It's Easy To Skip To The Sections They Need To Visit, Grab What They Need, And Leave. However, It Is Exactly This Grab-And-Go Attitude That Will Hurt Other Types Of Retail Stores: They Don't Exactly Invite Leisurely Browsing.



15. Explain the role of spot and LED strip lighting in product display. [U] / [CO4]

Ans:-

SPOT LIGHTING

Spot Lighting Is A More Focused And Intense Form Of Accent Lighting. It Directs A Narrow Beam Of Light On A Particular Product Or Small Area, Making It The Center Of Attention. This Type Of Lighting Is Commonly Used In Luxury Retail Or High-End Product Displays, Where Items Like Jewelry, Watches, Or Designer Pieces Need To Be Highlighted With Precision And Drama. Spot Lighting Adds A Sense Of Importance And Exclusivity, Making The Product Stand Out From Its Surroundings. It Also Enhances Texture, Color, And Form Of The Item, Offering A More Realistic And Appealing View.

LED STRIP LIGHTING.

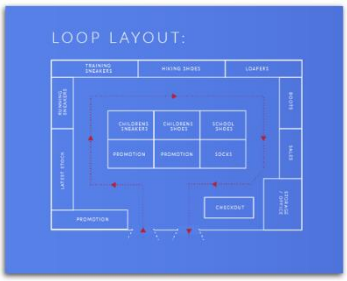
LED Strip Lighting Is A Modern And Versatile Lighting Method That Consists Of Small Leds Placed On A Flexible Strip. It Is Used To Enhance Shelves, Display Cases, Mirrors, And Counters With A Subtle Glow. LED Strips Help To Outline Spaces, Highlight Architectural Features, And Create A Contemporary Look. They Are Available In Various Colors And Brightness Levels And Can Even Be Programmed To Change Colors Or Patterns. LED Strip Lighting Is Not Only Aesthetically Pleasing But Also Energy-Efficient And Generates Little Heat, Making It Safe And Cost-Effective For Retail Environments.

16. Compare the racetrack layout with a free – flow layout in term of customer traffic control. [U] / [CO1, CO2]

Ans:-

LOOP(RACETRACK) LAYOUT

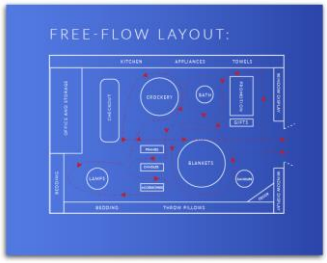
Box With An Island In The Middle. It Can Be Used In A Small Space, Or In A Big Box Store That Will Benefit From Zoning (Thus Creating Several Areas With Loop Layouts). Contrary To Its Name, A “Racetrack” Retail Store Layout Is Actually The Better Choice For A More Relaxed Shopping Experience. The Loop Is A Simple But Guided Experience: Customers Have A Logical Path To Follow, And This Clear Sense Of Where To Go Next Lends Itself To A Great Storytelling Opportunity. The Tendency To Turn Right And Then Follow A Path Means Your Biggest, Most Eye-Catching Display Will Work Well On The Wall Immediately To The Right Of The Entrance. The Cash Register Should Then Be Positioned To The Immediate Left Of The Entrance — In Other Words, The Logical “End Of The Path.”



FREE FLOW LAYOUT

The Free-Flow Is A Favourite With Upscale Retailers. This Floor Plan Is Open, With Lots Of Opportunities For Creativity, Switching Things Up, And Creating Special Focus Zones. With This Floor Plan, There Are Open Sight Lines Throughout The Store. This Means A Power Wall Can Be Made Visible From Any Angle. It Also Means You Can Create Mini

Experiences In Different Zones. Since There Are No Definite Traffic Flows, This Layout Works Best For A Store That Has A Smaller Inventory And Necessitates Slower Browsing.



17. Discuss the key differences between a waterfall stand and a four-way stand. [U] / [CO3]

Ans:-

WATERFALL STAND

- Waterfall Stands Are Slanted Display Arms That Hold Garments In A Cascading Layout, With Each Piece Slightly Lower Than The One Above It. This Arrangement Offers A Clear View Of Each Item And Is Especially Useful For Displaying Clothes In A Series (Like Different Colors Or Sizes). The Visual Flow Created By The Waterfall Effect Adds A Dynamic And Attractive Element To Apparel Displays.

FOURWAY STAND

- Four-Way Stands, Also Known As 4-Arm Racks, Feature Four Arms Extending In Different Directions From A Central Pole. These Are Excellent For Displaying Multiple Styles Or Color Variations Of A Garment. Four-Way Stands Are Often Used In The Middle Of The Store Floor And Provide A Full View Of The Merchandise From All Angles, Encouraging Customer Engagement And Making The Most Of Available Space.

18. Explain the use of matte textures with examples. [U] / [CO4]

Ans:-

MATTE TEXTURE

- Non-Reflective, Muted Finish (Eg :- Matte Paint, Cotton Fabric).
- Symbolizes Subtlety, Simplicity, Calmness.
- Psychological Impact: Relaxing, Sophisticated, Soft Appeal.

19. What are the main roles of stands in retail setting?

Ans:-

STANDS

Stands Are Versatile Display Fixtures Used To Highlight Specific Products Or Collections In A Retail Environment. They Come In Various Designs And Sizes, And Can Be Placed Anywhere On The Shop Floor To Draw Customer Attention To Featured Items, Promotions, Or New Arrivals. Stands Are Effective For Creating Focal Points And Guiding Customer Flow Throughout The Store. [K] / [CO3]

- Helps To Organized Product Display
- For Efficient Space Optimization

- Proper Customer Navigation
- Enhance Visual Presentation
- Helps To Increase Sales
- It Reflects Brand Identity

20. Explain how product merchandising help in increase sales. [U] / [CO1]

Ans:-

Product Merchandising: Strategically Placing And Displaying Products To Maximize Sales And Visibility.

Visual Merchandising Is The Art Of Designing And Presenting; Merchandise And The Retail Aesthetics At Their Very Best, For Engaging Customers And Convey Brand Identity With The End Purpose Of Making Sales. We May Not Actually Sell The Object Displayed Or The Idea Promoted, But We Do Attempt To Convince The Viewer Of The Value Of The Object, The Store Promoting The Object, Or The Organization Behind The Concept. Although A Cash Register May Not Ring Because Of A Particular Display, That Display Should Make An Impression On The Viewer That Will Affect Future Sales.The Display Person Used To Be The Purveyor Of Dreams And Fantasies, Presenting Merchandise In Settings That Stirred The Imagination And Promoted Fantastic Flights To Unattainable Heights. **[4x5 = 20]**

Part C

Essay Questions

Answer any **3** questions

Each question carries **10** marks

21. Discuss the importance of interior displays and its types. [U] / [CO1,CO2]

Ans:-

INTERIOR DISPLAY

Interior Displays Are Visual Elements Created Within A Store To Showcase Products, Promote Sales, And Enhance The Shopping Experience. Effective Interior Displays Can:

- Attract Customers' Attention
- Communicate Product Information
- Create An Engaging Atmosphere
- Drive Sales
- Reinforce The Brand's Identity

TYPES

- Shelf Displays: Products Arranged On Shelves To Create An Attractive And Accessible Display.
- Fixture Displays: Displays Created Using Store Fixtures, Such As Gondolas, Racks, Or Tables.
- Point-Of-Purchase (POP) Displays: Displays Near Checkout Counters Or Sales Areas To Promote Impulse Buys.
- Thematic Displays: Displays Centred Around A Specific Theme, Season, Or Promotion.

- Endcap Displays: Displays Placed At The End Of Aisles To Showcase Products.
- Countertop Displays: Small Displays Placed On Counters To Promote Products.
- Wall Displays: Displays Mounted On Walls To Showcase Products Or Create A Visual Impact.
- Floor Displays: Large Displays Placed On The Floor To Showcase Products Or Create A Focal Point.

22. What is fixtures and its functions. [K] / [CO3]

Ans:-

FIXTURES

Fixtures Are Any Equipment Or Furniture Used To Display Or Hold Merchandise In A Retail Store. This Includes Shelving Units, Wall Mounts, Display Tables, And More. It Can Be Permanent Or Semi-Permanent Display Units. In A Fashion Store, Fixtures Play A Vital Role In Showcasing Clothing, Accessories, And Footwear In A Visually Appealing And Accessible Manner.

Functions And Importance

- Helps To Organized Product Display
- For Efficient Space Optimization
- Proper Customer Navigation
- Enhance Visual Presentation
- Helps To Increase Sales
- It Reflects Brand Identity

TYPES OF FIXTURES

Stands, T Stands, Carousels, Counters & Showcases, Waterfall Stand, Fourway Stand, Racks, Round Racks, Platforms, Dump Bins.

23. Discuss how textures can influence perceptions of product quality and luxury. [U] / [CO4]

Ans:-

TEXTURES IN DISPLAY MERCHANDISING

Texture Refers To The Surface Quality Of A Material—How It Feels Or Looks (Smooth, Rough, Shiny, Matte, Soft, Hard).

In Display Merchandising, Texture Refers To The Surface Quality Or "Feel" Of Objects And Materials Used In A Display, Encompassing Visual And Tactile Qualities Like Smooth, Rough, Shiny, Or Matte Surfaces. Strategic Use Of Texture Enhances Depth And Visual Interest, Draws Customers In, Communicates Brand Identity, And Influences Perceptions Of Quality, Sophistication, Or Ruggedness, Ultimately Affecting The Overall Shopping Experience.

IMPORTANCE IN DISPLAY

- Adds Depth And Dimension To Flat Displays.
- Helps Convey The Nature Of The Product Before Touching.
- Makes Displays More Realistic, Engaging, And Sensory Appealing.
- Example:
  - A Woolen Texture In A Window Display Suggests Warmth For Winter.
  - A Shiny Glass Texture Highlights Modern Or Luxury Products.

TYPES OF TEXTURES

1. Smooth Texture:
   - Polished, Sleek Surfaces (Glass, Silk, Metal).
   - Symbolizes Modernity, Luxury, Elegance.
   - Psychological Impact: Feels Clean, Neat, High-Class.
2. Rough Texture:
   - Uneven, Rugged Surfaces (Wood, Wool, Stone).
   - Symbolizes Rawness, Natural Feel, Strength.
   - Psychological Impact: Gives Rustic, Earthy, Homely Vibe.
3. Shiny/Glossy Texture:
   - Reflective (Mirror, Polished Metal, Satin).
   - Symbolizes Glamour, Attraction, Boldness.
   - Psychological Impact: Eye-Catching, Feels Rich And Premium.
4. Matte Texture:
   - Non-Reflective, Muted Finish (Matte Paint, Cotton Fabric).
   - Symbolizes Subtlety, Simplicity, Calmness.
   - Psychological Impact: Relaxing, Sophisticated, Soft Appeal.

24. Explain the pipe racks and discuss the types of stores where they are commonly used. [U] / [CO3]

Ans:-

RACKS

Racks Are Essential Merchandising Tools In Apparel Retail. They Consist Of Horizontal Bars Supported By Frames And Are Used To Hang Garments Efficiently. Available In Various Configurations Such As Single-Rail Or Multi-Tier, Racks Allow For Easy Browsing And Are Suitable For Both Front-Of-Store And Stock-Heavy Areas. They Help Organize Clothing By Size, Style, Or Category.

TYPES OF RACKS

- ROUND RACKS

Round Racks Are Circular Versions Of Standard Racks, Allowing Garments To Be Displayed In A 360-Degree Format. These Racks Can Hold A Large Volume Of Clothing And Are Commonly Used For Clearance Or Promotional Items. Customers Can Walk Around The Rack To View All Items, Making It A Practical Fixture For High-Traffic Areas.

- PIPE RACKS

Pipe Racks Are Display Units Constructed From Industrial-Style Metal Piping. Known For Their Durability And Stylish Appeal, Pipe Racks Are Especially Popular In Modern, Minimalist, Or Urban-Themed Stores. They Offer A Raw, Contemporary Look While Providing Strong Support For Hanging Heavy Garments Or Layered Displays.

25. Explain in detail about the Mannequins and Mannequin Alternatives. [U] / [CO3]

Ans:-

MANNEQUINS

Mannequins Are Essential Tools In The Fashion And Retail Industries, Used To Display Clothing, Accessories, And Footwear In A Way That Helps Customers Visualize How The Items Would Look When Worn. And They Help Displays More Engaging And Inspiring

Purchase Decisions. Mannequins Also Contribute To The Overall Theme And Aesthetic Of The Store, Helping To Convey Brand Identity And Lifestyle Messaging.

DIFFERENT TYPES OF MANNEQUINS

- Realistic
- Semi Realistic
- Abstract
- Headless.

MANNEQUIN ALTERNATIVES

- Partial Mannequins
- Dress Forms
- Hangers
- Flat Lay Display
- Costumers
- Flexible Rod Forms

[10x3 = 30]

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